# Aaron Stagoff-Belfort

University of Chicago
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## Education

**University of Chicago** 2023–present
Ph.D. in Sociology; M.A. in Sociology
Dissertation: "Governing Against the City: Police Unions and Urban Governance"
Committee: Robert Vargas (chair), Geoffrey Wodtke, Julian Go, Gerard Torrats-Espinosa (Columbia)

**Wesleyan University** 2018
B.A., College of Social Studies

## Research Interests

Policing, Urban Sociology, Race & Ethnicity, Inequality, Quantitative Methodology

## Employment & Research Experience

**Graduate Research Scholar**, Justice Policy Lab, Watson Institute, Brown University 2026–present

**Graduate Student Research Scholar**, Policing Project, NYU School of Law 2025–present

**Research Assistant**, UChicago Justice Project 2023–2026

**Program Associate**, Vera Institute of Justice 2019–2023

**Research Assistant**, *New York Times* 2017–2018

## Peer-Reviewed Publications

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, Jon Ben-Menachem,* and Brenden Beck. 2025. "Can Speed Cameras Make Streets Safer? Quasi-Experimental Evidence From New York City." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.*

Press: Vital City, Streetsblog NYC. Top 5% of all research outputs scored by Altmetric; 99th percentile Attention Score relative to outputs of the same age.

Leah G. Pope, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2023. "Competing Concerns in Efforts to Reduce Criminal Legal System Entanglement among People with Serious Mental Illnesses: Findings from a Multi-City Study on Misdemeanor Arrests." *Administration and Policy in Mental Health and Mental Health Services Research* 50(5–6).

Michael T. Compton, Leah G. Pope, Amanda Warnock, Nili Gesser, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2023. "Contexts Shaping Misdemeanor System Interventions with People Affected by Mental Illnesses: Findings from a Multi-City System Mapping Exercise." *Health and Justice* 11.

Michael T. Compton, Adria Zern, Leah G. Pope, Nili Gesser, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2022. "Misdemeanor Charges Among Individuals with Serious Mental Illnesses: A Statewide Analysis of More Than Two Million Arrests." *Psychiatric Services.*

*Denotes graduate student coauthor.

## Book Chapters

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort** and Jason Tan de Bibiana. 2024. "Being in the Wrong Place: Criminal Trespass and Criminal Legal System Entanglement." In *Entangled: How People with Serious Mental Illnesses Get and Stay Caught up in Misdemeanor Systems*, edited by Leah G. Pope, Amy C. Watson, Jennifer D. Wood, and Michael T. Compton. Washington, DC: APA Publishing.

## Under Review

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, Ángela Zorro Medina, David Hackett, and Robert Vargas. "The Diffusion of Policing Alternatives in U.S. Cities After the George Floyd Protests." *Conditionally Accepted, American Sociological Review.*

## Work in Progress

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort** and Devin Green. "Black Power, Blue Power: The Civil Rights Movement and the Origin of Police Unions."

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort** and Jonathan Ben-Menachem. "Promotion Practices and Police Behavior: Merit Sergeants, Supervisory Legitimacy, and Officer Misconduct."

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, Preeti Chauhan, Richie Lin, and Therese L. Todd. "Does Crisis Intervention Training Change How Police Handle Mental Health Calls? Evidence from Seattle's 40-hour Crisis Intervention Team (CIT) Training."

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort** and David Hackett. "When Policing Technology is Discontinued: Response Times and Crime After Chicago's ShotSpotter Decommission."

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, Roman Rivera, and Matthew Ross. Seattle Deterrence Study (title forthcoming).

## Book Reviews

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**. 2026. Review of *Blue Power: How Police Organized to Protect and Serve Themselves*, by Stuart Schrader. *Sociological Forum*. https://doi.org/10.1111/socf.70073

## Other Publications

Jason Tan de Bibiana, Kerry Mulligan, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, and Daniela Gilbert. 2023. "Coordinating Safety: Building and Sustaining Offices of Violence Prevention and Neighborhood Safety." Vera Institute of Justice.

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, Dan Bodah, and Daniela Gilbert. 2022. "The Social Costs of Policing." Vera Institute of Justice.

Jackson Beck, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, and Jason Tan de Bibiana. 2022. "Civilian Crisis Response: A Toolkit for Equitable Alternatives to Policing." Vera Institute of Justice.

**Aaron Stagoff-Belfort** and Mary Fleck. 2021. "Reducing Policing's Footprint? Racial Disparities and Arrest Trends After Misdemeanor Decriminalization and Legalization in Denver and Philadelphia." Vera Institute of Justice.

## Grants & Fellowships

**Stigler Center PhD Dissertation Award** (Bradley Fellow), University of Chicago Booth School of Business ($5,000) 2026

**Crime, Law, and Deviance Section Award**, American Sociological Association ($500) 2026

**Charles R. Henderson Research Fund Grant**, University of Chicago ($2,000) 2026

**Graduate Research Fellowship**, National Science Foundation ($159,000) 2025

**Charles R. Henderson Research Fund Grant**, University of Chicago ($3,500) 2025

**Research Grant**, Midwest Sociological Society ($2,500) 2025

**Urban Doctoral Fellowship**, Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation, University of Chicago ($1,000) 2024

## Honors & Awards

**Wayne C. Booth Graduate Student Prize for Excellence in Teaching**, University of Chicago 2026

**1st Place, Graduate Student Paper Competition**, Midwest Sociological Society 2025

## Conference Presentations

**2026:** Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS), Northwestern Pritzker School of Law; Harvard Urban Data Lab; Law & Society Association Annual Meeting; Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Annual Meeting; American Sociological Association Annual Meeting; Northwestern Urban Workshop; Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting; New School Carceral Political Economy Conference; UChicago Stone Center Inequality Working Group

**2025:** Arnold Ventures and George Mason University: Justice Reimagined; American Sociological Association Annual Meeting; Society for the Study of Social Problems Annual Meeting; American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; UChicago Spring Institute; UChicago Race & Racial Ideologies Working Group

**2024:** American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; UChicago Critical Social Science Initiative

**2023:** American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting

**2022:** American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; Motion for Justice National Convening, Vera Institute of Justice

**2021:** Temple Law Review and Center for Public Health Law Research Symposium; Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences Annual Meeting

## Teaching Experience

**University of Chicago**

Teaching Assistant, *Regression and Generalized Linear Models* (Prof. Geoffrey Wodtke) 2026

Teaching Assistant, *Cities, Space, Power: Intro to Urban Social Science* (Prof. Neil Brenner) 2026

Teaching Assistant, *Statistical Methods of Research II* (Prof. Geoffrey Wodtke) 2025

Teaching Assistant, *Introduction to Applied Statistics and Data Science* (Prof. Marshall Jean) 2025

**The Petey Greene Program**

Prison Education Tutor 2020–2023

## Professional Service

**Assistant Editor**, *American Journal of Sociology* 2025–present

**Journal Referee:** *Police Quarterly*, *Annals of Internal Medicine*

## Affiliations

American Sociological Association (ASA); American Society of Criminology (ASC); Law & Society Association (LSA)

## References

**Robert Vargas**, University of Chicago, robvargas@uchicago.edu
**Julian Go**, University of Chicago, jgo34@uchicago.edu
**Geoffrey Wodtke**, University of Chicago, gwodtke@uchicago.edu
**Gerard Torrats-Espinosa**, Columbia University, gerard.torrats@columbia.edu
**Brenden Beck**, Rutgers University, brenden.beck@rutgers.edu